



Coding Standards

Last Revision: July 13 2026

David van Rooijen

Dandré Nel

Daniel Cohen

Stephan Kritzinger

Michael Koch



TABLE OF CONTENTS

File Structure.....	2
Naming conventions (Backend).....	3
Naming conventions (Frontend).....	4
Coding Style.....	4
Linters and configuration.....	6
Before Commits.....	10
Github/Git.....	10
Changelog.....	10

File Structure

NOTE: Emdash was copypasted since it makes a better horizontal line than the dash on my keyboard.

```
Savanna-Sentinel/  
|  
|--backend/  
|   |--init-db/           #Contains files to seed and initialise the  
database  
|   |--tests/             #Contains the test files for the backend  
|       |--integration/   #Contains the integration test files  
|       |--unit/          #Contains the unit test files  
|   |--app/  
|       |--api/           #Contains the files used by various aspects of  
fastAPI  
|       |--v1/            #Contains route information  
|       |--core/          #Contains helper functions and some config  
files  
|       |--models/        #Contains the database table structure  
|       |--repositories/  #Contains files to interface with the database  
and retrieve data from the database  
|       |--schemas/       #Contains DTO's and ViewModels to ensure data  
integrity  
|       |--services/      #Contains main API functionality which router  
executes  
|       |--workers/       #Contains celery/redis workers  
|   |--Dockerfile  
|   |--requirements.txt   #Contains Package information  
|   |--.env               #User-generated file, contains keys and  
secrets.  
|--frontend/  
|   |--public/  
|       |--icons/         #Contains static content used throughout the  
dashboard  
|   |--src/               #Contains most frontend functionality  
|       |--components/  
|       |--ui/            #Contains general re-usable components that are  
used on multiple pages
```

```

|           └─{page_name}/#Contains reusable components specific to that
page
|           └─hooks/      #Contains interceptors for every request when
activated for the page.
|           └─lib/        #Contains helper functions
|           └─offline/    #Contains offline functionality for PWA
|           └─pages/      #Contains the raw page code for each route
|           └─services/   #Contains API call functions and helper
functions
|           └─store/      #Contains persistent data for the session
|           └─styles/     #Contains scss files
|           └─tests/      #Contains frontend testing files
|               └─mocks/   #Contains mocks for unit tests
|               └─{file.test.tsx}
|           └─App.tsx     #The containing page of the SPA and also
routing
|           └─main.tsx    #Wrapper for the App page
|           └─Dockerfile
|           └─.env        #Frontend environment configuration
└─docs/
|   └─architecture/
|   └─design/
|   └─drafts/            #Contains .md drafts of docs, before formatting
has occurred and transformed to pdf
|   └─non-functional/
|   └─requirements/
|   └─research/          #Contains research of AI methods to be used
└─docker-compose.yml

```

Naming conventions (Backend)

- File - Snake Case (e.g. user_service.py)
- Methods - Snake Case
- Variables - Snake Case
- Classes & Interfaces - Pascal Case
- Folders - Attempt 1 word folder names, otherwise kebab case (e.g. init-db)
- Constants - Upper Snake Case (e.g. CONSTANT_VARIABLE)

Naming conventions (Frontend)

- Files w/ Components - Pascal Case (e.g. DataPreview.tsx)
- Files w/ Helpers - Camel Case
- Methods - Camel Case (Matching React Syntax)
- Variables - Camel Case
- Components - Pascal Case
- Folders - Attempt 1 word folder names, otherwise kebab case
- Constant Globals - UPPER SNAKE CASE (Otherwise follow Camel Case like a normal variable)

Coding Style

Adapted from [PEP 8](#), although with modifications.

- Never exceed 80 characters on a line
 - Make a new line at a logical location if threatening to exceed the limit.
- Either define all formal parameters on the same line, or each one on a new line with extra indentation from the body to ensure readability. E.g.

Correct

```
async def admin_delete_user(
    user_id: str,
    db: AsyncSession = Depends(get_db),
    current_admin: User = Depends(require_admin)
):
    repo = UserRepository(db)
    service = UserService(repo)
```

```
async def change_role(self, user_id: str, new_role: str):
    result = await self.repo.update_role(user_id, new_role)
    return result
```

- Separate logical sections inside a method with a single blank line.
- Separate method definitions with a single blank line
 - This can be ignored if methods are related and minimal, such as getters or setters.
- Separate logical groups of methods with 2 blank lines.
- All boolean variables must contain a prefix that phrases the variable as a question. (e.g. is_correct/isCorrect)
- Imports must only be at the very top of the file.

- Include all method imports from a single package onto a single line or encapsulate in brackets
- All Globals must be defined under imports
- All strings must be encapsulated with double quotes(""), using ` for template strings when necessary. Single quotes(') should be avoided to list a string.
 - Triple double quotes(''') must be used for docstrings
- Arrays or similar data structures must include a trailing comma, for easy expansion later. E.g.

```
example_array = {
  "data_item_1": "test",
  "data_item_2": "test2", <-- trailing comma
}
```

- All arrays must use the above syntax, with 1 item being included per line
- All functions must define a return type, with typed Python or TypeScript interfaces.
 - The use of the any type should be avoided.
- Strict Equality should be used when possible (=== over ==)
- The use of the var word in the frontend is forbidden, use modern JS syntax such as let or const, preferring const unless the variable is designed to be changing.
- Binary operators must be surrounded by 2 empty spaces (1 + 2)
- Attempt to keep all variable declarations at the top of their respective block scope.
- Comments must be placed above the method/line they are explaining
 - Inline comments are forbidden.
- Arrow syntax (=>) is preferred for Javascript function definitions.
- A frontend file that contains Markdown language (<tag>) must use the .tsx file extension. Else .ts must be used.
- All props must be destructured inside their component definition

Correct

```
const ExampleComp = ({itemId, isValid}) => {
  ...
}
```

Incorrect

```
const ExampleComp = (props: ExampleCompProps) => {
  const itemId: string = props.itemId
}
```

Linters and configuration

Eslint

```
export default defineConfig([
  globalIgnores(["dist", "coverage", "web-build"]),
  {
    ignores: ["src/components/ui", "vite.config.ts"],
  },
  {
    files: ["**/*.ts", "**/*.tsx"],
    plugins: {
      "@stylistic": stylistic,
      react: reactPlugin,
    },
    extends: [
      js.configs.recommended,
      ...tseslint.configs.recommended,
      reactHooks.configs.flat.recommended,
      reactRefresh.configs.vite,
    ],
    languageOptions: {
      globals: globals.browser,
      parser: tseslint.parser,
      parserOptions: {
        project: ["/tsconfig.app.json"],
        tsconfigRootDir: import.meta.dirname,
        ecmaFeatures: {
          jsx: true,
        },
      },
    },
    settings: {
      react: {
        version: "19.2",
      },
    },
    rules: {
```

```

    //Enforce strict equality
    eqeqeq: ["error", "always"],
    "no-var": "error",
    "prefer-const": "error",
    //typescript rules
    //If overloads are not consecutive, throw an error
    "@typescript-eslint/adjacent-overload-signatures": "error",
    "@typescript-eslint/array-type": ["error", { default: "array"
  }],

  //Enforce variable names according to standard
  "@typescript-eslint/naming-convention": [
    "error",
    {
      selector: "variable",
      types: ["boolean"],
      //Eslint will strip out the is has should words when
      parsing due to the prefix rule, so Pascal is used to avoid the error.
      //Camel should be used in all cases
      format: ["PascalCase"],
      prefix: ["is", "has", "should", "can", "show"],
    },
    {
      selector: "variable",
      types: ["function"],
      format: ["camelCase", "PascalCase"],
    },
    {
      selector: ["function", "method"],
      format: ["camelCase", "PascalCase"],
      leadingUnderscore: "allow",
    },
    {
      selector: "variable",
      format: ["camelCase"],
      leadingUnderscore: "allow",
    },
    {
      selector: ["typeLike"],
      format: ["PascalCase"],
    },
  ],

```



```

        {
            selector: "variable",
            modifiers: ["global"],
            format: ["UPPER_CASE", "camelCase"],
        },
    ],
    "react/destructuring-assignment": ["error", "always"],
    "@stylistic/line-comment-position": [
        "error",
        { position: "above" },
    ],
},
]);

```

Prettier

```

{
  "printWidth": 80,
  "tabWidth": 4,
  "useTabs": false,
  "semi": true,
  "singleQuote": false,
  "jsxSingleQuote": false,
  "quoteProps": "as-needed",
  "trailingComma": "all",
  "bracketSpacing": true,
  "bracketSameLine": false,
  "objectWrap": "preserve",
  "arrowParens": "always"
}

```

Ruff

```

# https://docs.astral.sh/ruff/rules/
[tool.ruff]

```

```

target-version = "py311"
line-length = 80
[tool.ruff.lint]
# E - PEP8
# W - PEP8
# F - Find basic errors and undefined variables
# I - Sort import statements and blocks
# N - Enforce Case constraints
# D - Docstring rules
# COM - Enforce trailing commas
# Q - Enforce string quote rules
# TCH - Enforce type checking
select = ["E", "W", "F", "I", "N", "D", "COM", "Q", "TCH"]
ignore = [
    "D100",
    "D104",
    "D102",
    "D103",
    "D107",
    "D101",
]
[tool.ruff.lint.pydocstyle]
convention = "pep257"
[tool.ruff.lint.extend-per-file-ignores]
# Ignore missing docstrings in test files
"tests/**/*.py" = ["D103", "D102", "D107", "D101"]
[tool.ruff.lint.flake8-quotes]
inline-quotes = "double"
multiline-quotes = "double"
docstring-quotes = "double"
[tool.ruff.lint.pep8-naming]
# Classes & Interfaces - PascalCase
# Methods & Variables - snake_case
# Constants - UPPER_SNAKE_CASE
classmethod-decorators = ["classmethod"]
[tool.ruff.format]
quote-style = "double"
indent-style = "space"
skip-magic-trailing-comma = false
docstring-code-format = true

```

Before Commits

- Ensure all testing and linting is run locally before committing, to improve CI success rate.
- Ensure PR have a clear description, and also mention parts that might need to be investigated further.

Github/Git

- All commits and pushes made directly to github must be made on a branch of dev
 - Dev and main are not allowed to be pushed to directly, code can only enter through PR's through review of a separate developer.
- All branch names must follow the following convention type/name
 - Type consists of
 - Fix
 - Task
 - Feature
 - Name is a short description of what is being done in snake case.
- All CI must succeed before a PR can be accepted
 - In rare circumstances, such as SonarQube failing, the team leader may make an executive decision to ignore it after careful review
 - Failing test cases cannot be ignored nor bypassed.
- All commits must have a short but descriptive message as to the commits contents.

Changelog

V2.1

[13 July 2026]

- Updated linters to their current configuration
- Minor improvements